## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** the learner bows to a young teacher | An elder honours a child. |
| 2 | **(b)** simile | Uses 'like'. |
| 3 | **(c)** does not suggest this; it only praises | No hatred is present. |
| 4 | **(b)** turn helplessness into resolve | Her emotion triggers action. |
| 5 | **(b)** metaphor | Direct comparison without 'like'. |
| 6 | **(c)** it may sound like boasting | A critic could say it is partial. |
| 7 | **(b)** Willpower can outweigh age | Her success proves it. |
| 8 | **(c)** I have told you a thousand times to read. | Deliberate exaggeration. |
| 9 | **(b)** a balanced view | Both fierce and kind. |
| 10 | **(c)** they are underestimated | She laughed first. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | She links a small event to larger ideas of learning and respect (1). Specific details make it believable and relevant to all (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Both set out with a wish and change course thoughtfully (1). Both find happiness in a choice beyond self (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Patriotism is love with gratitude (1). Boasting puts others down, which the poem does not (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Granddaughter and grandmother exchange knowledge and respect (1). The old and the young learn from each other (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | The grandmother faced fear and age (1). The narrator's skill was needed too (1). Courage drove the process, but both were required (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Yes, as girls were kept from school (1). Her loss was society's loss (1). Yet she corrected it late, showing individual power (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | It recalls sages and old books (1). It places the present in a line of tradition (1). It passes love of the land to new readers (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Old women are thought unable to learn (1). The grandmother proves otherwise (1). A young girl becomes a respected teacher (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Although she was old, she worked hard and succeeded (1). 'Although' introduces the subordinate clause (1). The main clause carries two actions (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Love implies care (1). Singing her glory includes protecting it (1). Readers may carry that duty (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Grandmother begins at sixty-two (1). Goal-setting and practice (1). Teacher's humility (1). Result at Dassara (1). Universal message of learning at any age (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Theme and mood (1). Imagery and personification (1). Refrain and rhythm (1). Language (1). Overall effect and personal view (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Initially amused and doubtful (1). Then patient and caring (1). Responsible teacher (1). Moved by the final gesture (1). Matures with new respect for learners (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Nature: mountains and rivers (1). Culture: sages and scriptures (1). One supports the other (1). Refrain unites them (1). Result: complete picture of a land (1). | 2+2+1 |

**Mistakes to avoid:**

- Writing that **Sudha Murty** is the grandmother, or that the grandmother is the author. The narrator is the granddaughter (the author) who teaches her grandmother, who began learning at about **sixty-two**.
- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.
- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** her gradual practice led to success | Persistence. |
| 2 | **(a)** third conditional | Had + would have. |
| 3 | **(a)** Both choose a larger goal after reflection | One chooses a girl's wedding; the other chooses learning. |
| 4 | **(c)** A Teacher at Any Age | Teacher at any age. |
| 5 | **(b)** future perfect | Will have + past participle. |
| 6 | **(b)** not supported by the story | Both can teach and learn. |
| 7 | **(c)** synonyms | Same meaning. |
| 8 | **(a)** Neither the grandmother nor the children were late. | The verb agrees with the nearer subject. |
| 9 | **(c)** to link learning with a sacred occasion | Dassara, with Saraswati, is for learning. |
| 10 | **(d)** building cumulative devotion | It adds up the praise. |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It makes the land feel familiar and loving (1). It invites readers to love it as they love a mother (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | If the grandmother failed, the theme would turn into struggle (1). The present ending keeps hope and inspires (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | She accepts the grandmother's bow with grace (1). It keeps the focus on the learner's achievement (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | It uses emotional words and a refrain (1). It ties nature to wisdom to build one image (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Dassara connects with learning (1). It gives a ritual setting to respect (1). It makes the moment memorable and moving (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | The novel was read by the grandmother on Dassara (1). Object becomes subject (1). Verb changes to 'was read' (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | In the story respect appears in the feet-touching act (1). In the poem it appears as praise (1). One is personal, the other national (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** The narrator does not exaggerate the tears or joy (1). Simple events carry weight (1). Readers feel the emotion themselves (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Sitting by the lamp, she practised letters (1). The participle replaces a clause (1). The subject stays the same (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Plain language suits the village setting (1). No ornament hides the feeling (1). Readers focus on character and message (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | It is a custom reversed (1). It shows humility (1). It honours knowledge (1). It moves the narrator (1). It sums up the theme (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Format (1). Introduction citing the poem (1). Meaning of pride (1). Examples of action (1). Conclusion (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Old vs young (1). Illiterate vs literate (1). Helplessness vs independence (1). Doubt vs success (1). Contrasts make the message vivid (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Story inspires through a character's effort (1). Poem inspires through praise and emotion (1). Both build respect and gratitude (1). Both use warm tone (1). Together they promote humility and love (1). | 2+2+1 |

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- Giving the wrong reason for the grandmother's illiteracy. In her childhood girls were not sent to school; do not say she was lazy or had no time.

- Missing the theme: the story is about **learning at any age** and the respect a teacher earns, not just 'a grandmother who reads a serial'. Name the serial (*Kashi Yatre*) and the goal (reading a novel) when asked for details.
- In 'Bharat Our Land', calling the poem sad or critical. Its mood is proud and celebratory; naming only 'rhyme' for devices instead of **refrain, personification (mountains guard her) and imagery**.
- Tense slips such as *'She learn to read at sixty-two'*; the narrative needs the simple past (**learnt**). Also confusing the teacher and pupil roles when writing the summary.
- Copying lines of the lesson as the answer. Write 2-mark answers as a point plus a reason (1 + 1), in your own words, and quote only the key phrase.

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# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 1: **How I Taught My Grandmother to Read; Bharat Our Land** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(d)** firm decision | Determination. |
| 2 | **(c)** reverence for knowledge | Symbolic of reverence. |
| 3 | **(b)** personification | Peaks kiss like a person. |
| 4 | **(d)** capable : incapable | Prefix gives the opposite. |
| 5 | **(c)** be weakened | Persistence is key to the message. |
| 6 | **(a)** metaphor and personification | Land as mother is both. |
| 7 | **(a)** a granddaughter's memory | The memoir is the frame. |
| 8 | **(b)** age and ability to learn | Her age vs her success. |
| 9 | **(b)** praises nation and heritage | Love for country. |
| 10 | **(a)** balances emotion with humour and detail | The tone mixes feeling and wit. |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | It brings warmth and intimacy (1). We see the grandmother through the narrator's love (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | It was wise because it met a real need (1). It also gave her a sense of purpose and respect (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | The steady rhythm and repetition create a song-like feel (1). That feel makes praise sound sincere and shared (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | 'Our' makes the land shared by all (1). 'Land' stresses a physical and emotional home (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Humour in the narrator's doubts and the grandmother's homework (1). It lightens the mood (1). It makes the final emotion more powerful (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | At the end it serves as a conclusion (1). In the middle it interrupts and heightens emphasis (1). Position changes its rhythm and meaning (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Persistence (1). Humility (1). The value of education (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** She is also a teacher of persistence (1). She teaches humility (1). The narrator and readers learn from her (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Concrete: mountains and rivers (1). Abstract: glory and wisdom (1). The mix makes feeling visible (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Mention the situation and person (1). Describe what you learnt (1). Connect to the grandmother's humility (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | It sparks her love of reading (1). Its heroine's choice mirrors her own (1). The wish to follow it drives her learning (1). It gives the story a frame (1). It links entertainment with growth (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Date and greeting (1). Describe the first full reading (1). Her feelings about the teacher (1). Her sense of freedom (1). Hopes for other learners (1). | 2+2+1 |
| 20 | Headline and opening (1). The grandmother's loss (1). Benefits of education (1). Society's role (1). Closing call to action (1). | 2+2+1 |
| | **OR:** Education gives independence (1). Informed citizens love the land responsibly (1). The grandmother's learning is a gain for society (1). The poem praises heritage learnt through wisdom (1). Together they build a strong nation (1). | 2+2+1 |

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